

Notes on a Quiet Afternoon

Sample document

The rain started sometime after lunch and settled into the kind of steady, even sound that makes a room feel smaller than it is. Nobody moved to close the window. The air coming through was cool and smelled like wet pavement.

On the table there were three cups, two of them empty, and a stack of paper nobody had looked at since morning. The top page was a list. The list had been rewritten twice and was no shorter for it.

Later the rain thinned out and the light came back in low and yellow, the way it does in early autumn. Someone said it was a shame to waste an afternoon like that, and everyone agreed, and nobody got up.

Second thoughts

A page of plain text is the fairest test of a reader: nothing to hide behind, no clever layout, just type on paper and whether it looks right.